



Social Science Part 1 — Cbse Half-Yearly Exam — 80 Marks

ANSWER KEY — FOR GRADING

Subject: Social Science Part 1 | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 80 | Time Allowed: 3h | CBSE

General Instructions:

1. Read all questions carefully before answering.
2. All questions are compulsory unless stated otherwise.
3. Marks for each question are indicated on the right.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section A Attempt all 20 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).		
1	Autonomous District Councils (ADCs) are established in which specific regions of India? (A) Southern regions (B) North-eastern regions (C) Central regions (D) Western regions Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. North-eastern regions — In specific north-eastern regions, Autonomous District Councils are established, granting them legislative and judicial authority to preserve tribal customs. [Ch 6: Democracy]	1
2	What were the earliest sources of information about early China called? (A) Papyrus scrolls stored in labeled jars (B) Oracles made on animal bones and tortoise shells (C) Inscriptions on bronze ritual vessels (D) Clay tablets with cuneiform writing Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. Oracles made on animal bones and tortoise shells, because these were symbols made on bones and shells that were heated until they cracked, and interpretations were based on the crack patterns. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
3	During the Mesolithic period, what was the mainstay of the subsistence economy? (A) Cultivation of wheat and barley (B) Fishing, enabled by a variety of microlithic tools to gather aquatic food (C) Hunting large game animals with handaxes and cleavers (D) Domestication of sheep, goats, and cattle Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. A variety of microlithic tools enabled people to gather aquatic food—both marine and freshwater—and fishing was the mainstay of their subsistence economy during the Mesolithic period. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	1
4	The colourful display of light seen in the sky near the poles is known as Aurora Borealis in the Northern Hemisphere. What is it called in the Southern Hemisphere? (A) Aurora Australis (B) Aurora Solaris (C) Aurora Borealis Australis (D) Aurora Polaris Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. The phenomenon is known as Aurora Borealis in the Northern Hemisphere and Aurora Australis in the Southern Hemisphere. It occurs when solar wind particles interact with atmospheric gases near the magnetic poles. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	1
5	What is the minimum age at which every citizen has the right to vote through a secret ballot in India? (A) 16 years of age and above (B) 18 years of age and above (C) 21 years of age and above (D) 25 years of age and above Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. Every citizen, 18 years of age and above, has the right to vote through a secret ballot. This right is known as the Universal Adult Franchise. [Ch 6: Democracy]	1
6	Which of the following best explains why Social Science is relevant to everyday life? (A) It only helps us memorise dates and locations of historical events (B) It focuses exclusively on the study of natural phenomena like physics and chemistry (C) It helps us understand how daily activities rely on systems of governance, economic production, social cooperation, and the natural environment (D) It replaces the need for all other academic disciplines	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. Even the simplest daily activities rely on systems of governance, economic production, social cooperation, and the natural environment, which Social Science helps us understand. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
7	Geography helps answer questions like why India has historically been a hub of global interaction. What geographical feature is cited as facilitating contact with Africa, Europe, and Southeast Asia? (A) The Himalayan mountain range (B) The Thar Desert (C) The Indo-Gangetic plain (D) The Indian peninsula's long coastline Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. The Indian peninsula's long coastline facilitated contact with Africa, Europe, and Southeast Asia, making India historically a hub of global interaction. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	1
8	Approximately how many registered political parties does India have? (A) Over 2,800 (B) Over 1,500 (C) Over 3,500 (D) Over 5,000 Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Over 2,800 — India has over 2,800 registered political parties, reflecting the country's social and regional diversity and allowing many viewpoints to compete peacefully. [Ch 6: Democracy]	1
9	What was the Kudavolai system used for in the Chola period? (A) A ballot pot system for village elections (B) A method of tax collection (C) A system of land distribution (D) A judicial procedure for settling disputes Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. The Kudavolai was the 'ballot pot' system used in village elections, where names of eligible candidates were written on palm leaves and placed inside a large pot for random selection. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
10	What marked the beginning of what is called 'human behaviour', as opposed to the behaviour of animals? (A) The making of the earliest stone tools around 3.3 million years ago (B) The domestication of animals during the Neolithic period (C) The invention of the bow and arrow by Homo sapiens (D) The development of pictographic script by the Harappans Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. The making of the earliest stone tools around 3.3 million years ago marked the beginning of 'human behaviour', as animals do not possess the cognitive ability to make such tools. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	1
11	Which of the following is NOT one of the four core disciplines that Social Science primarily draws from in Grades 9–10? (A) Anthropology (B) Geography (C) Political Science (D) Economics Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Anthropology is mentioned as part of the broader Social Science family but is not one of the four core disciplines in Grades 9–10, which are Geography, History, Political Science, and Economics. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	1
12	The Zabo system in Nagaland is an integrated farming approach that uses which of the following for soil and water conservation? (A) Earthen bunds on hillslopes (B) Terracing on flat plains (C) Concrete dams across rivers (D) Underground pipelines for irrigation Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. The Zabo system in Nagaland uses earthen bunds on hillslopes for soil and water conservation, along with check dams across small streams to reduce water velocity and prevent soil erosion. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	1
13	Which layer of the atmosphere contains the ozone gas that filters the Sun's harmful ultraviolet radiation? (A) Stratosphere (B) Mesosphere (C) Thermosphere (D) Exosphere	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. The stratosphere contains a layer of ozone gas which shields us by filtering the Sun's harmful radiation, including ultraviolet radiation. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	
14	Winds are named after the direction they blow from. What is a wind blowing from the west called? (A) Easterly (B) Westerly (C) Northerly (D) Southerly Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. Winds are named after the direction they blow from, so a wind blowing from the west is called westerly. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	1
15	What is the state of the asthenosphere that allows tectonic plates to move? (A) Completely solid (B) Completely liquid (C) Semi-molten (D) Gaseous Answer: Correct Option: (C) ► Why? C. The asthenosphere is semi-molten, which allows the tectonic plates to move on top of it. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	1
16	Which two stages among the four āśhramas of life clearly have a renunciatory connotation? (A) Brahmacharya and Gṛhastha (B) Gṛhastha and Vānaprastha (C) Brahmacharya and Saṃnyāsa (D) Vānaprastha and Saṃnyāsa Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. Among the four stages (āśhrama) of life, vānaprastha and saṃnyāsa clearly have a renunciatory connotation, reflecting the idea of non-attachment already present in the Vedic tradition. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
17	Which of the following tools is used by Geography to understand concepts and investigate questions? (A) Carbon-14 dating (B) Genealogical records (C) Numismatics (D) Geographical Information System (GIS) Answer: Correct Option: (D) ► Why? D. Geography uses maps, globes, atlases, Geographical Information System (GIS), infographics, and various other instruments to understand concepts. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	1
18	By the end of 1400 BCE, the Babylonians lost their prominence. Which combination of factors contributed to this decline? (A) Flooding of the Tigris River and a pandemic disease (B) Repeated attacks by the Hittites, environmental degradation, pressure on agricultural lands, and internal political and economic problems (C) Invasion by the Sumerians and a collapse of the cuneiform script (D) A long drought and the abandonment of cuneiform writing Answer: Correct Option: (B) ► Why? B. The Babylonians lost prominence due to repeated attacks by the Hittites and other rising powers who had mastered new technologies, along with increasing environmental degradation, pressure on agricultural lands, and internal political and economic problems. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	1
19	Which of the following statements correctly connects the role of landforms with the development of early civilisations and trade? (A) Rivers and fertile plains gave rise to agricultural societies, while deserts encouraged trade routes like the Silk Route (B) Deserts like the Thar encouraged the development of large settlements and discouraged trade (C) Coasts and harbours limited cultural contacts with distant lands (D) Mountains prevented all forms of trade and cultural exchange between regions Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. Rivers and fertile plains like those of the Ganga, Nile, Brahmaputra, and Indus gave rise to agricultural societies and early cities, while deserts like the Thar limited large settlements but encouraged trade routes such as the Silk Route. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	1



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
20	What is the primary mechanism by which Glacial Lake Outburst Floods (GLOFs) occur? (A) Sudden release of large volumes of water from glacial lakes due to natural and climatic factors (B) Overflow of rivers due to heavy monsoon rainfall (C) Melting of permafrost in tundra regions (D) Tsunami waves triggered by undersea earthquakes Answer: Correct Option: (A) ► Why? A. GLOFs are caused by the sudden release of large volumes of water from glacial lakes, often triggered by rapid melting of glaciers, heavy rainfall, earthquakes, avalanches, or landslides that weaken the natural dams of ice or loose moraines. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	1
Section B Attempt 5 out of 7.		
21	What is sustainable growth as described in the context of economic development? Answer: Sustainable growth is growth that meets present needs without harming the ability of future generations to meet theirs. It ensures resources are used wisely and fairly while promoting economic development as a central national goal. ► Why? The answer draws directly from the source's definition linking present needs with future generations' capacity, emphasizing wise and fair resource use. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	2
	OR How does the example of a drought demonstrate the need for multiple Social Science disciplines to understand society? Answer: A drought affects crops (environment), farmers' incomes (economy), government relief measures (politics), migration to cities (society), and traditional ways of coping with scarcity (culture). No single field can fully explain it, so multiple disciplines are needed for a comprehensive understanding. ► Why? The answer requires understanding how one event impacts multiple dimensions of society, justifying the multi-disciplinary nature of Social Science. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
22	What is the objective of the National Monsoon Mission (NMM)? Answer: The overall objective of the NMM, launched by the Ministry of Earth Sciences, is to enhance monsoon predictions for India over all time frames using state-of-the-art weather and climate prediction models. ► Why? The question tests knowledge of a specific government initiative mentioned in the source material and its purpose.	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	<i>[Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]</i>	
	OR What were the key inventions of the Sumerians related to their number system, and how do they influence us today? Answer: The Sumerians' number system was based on the number 60. They invented the concepts of the 60-minute hour, the 60-second minute, and the 360-degree circle. They also invented the wheeled cart and sailboat. ► Why? The question tests recall of Sumerian contributions to mathematics and technology that continue to influence modern systems. <i>[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]</i>	
23	What reservation for women does Article 243(d) provide in Panchayats, and how have some states gone further? Answer: Article 243(d) provides not less than one-third reservation for women in every Panchayat. However, 21 States and 2 Union Territories have gone further by making provisions of 50% reservation for women in Panchayati Raj Institutions. ► Why? This tests knowledge of constitutional provisions for women's reservation and how states have exceeded the minimum requirement. <i>[Ch 6: Democracy]</i>	2
24	What irrigation structure was built by Karikala Chola, and what does its continued use signify? Answer: The Grand Anicut (Kallanai) was built by Karikala Chola. It helped store and distribute water, supported agriculture, and encouraged settlement growth. Its continued use and repair by later rulers over many centuries, and its use even today, signify the lasting importance of Chola irrigation works. ► Why? The answer highlights the enduring legacy of Chola irrigation infrastructure and its long-term significance for agriculture. <i>[Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]</i>	2
25	What are Glacial Lake Outburst Floods (GLOFs) and what causes them? Answer: GLOFs are caused by the sudden release of large volumes of water from glacial lakes. Rapid melting of glaciers due to rising temperatures increases water levels, putting pressure on natural dams of ice or loose moraines. Earthquakes, avalanches, or landslides may weaken these dams, leading to sudden collapse and destructive downstream floods. ► Why? This tests understanding of the definition and multiple causative factors of GLOFs as described in the source material. <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	2



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
Section C Attempt 5 out of 7.		
26	How does understanding economics contribute to sustainable growth and the wise use of resources? Answer: Understanding economics helps us recognise both achievements and challenges in economic development, which remains a central national goal. It encourages us to think about how resources can be used more wisely and fairly. Importantly, economics promotes sustainable growth that meets present needs without harming the ability of future generations to meet theirs. By studying topics such as markets and prices, GDP, international trade, and the Union Budget, we understand how economic decisions affect individuals, communities, and the nation as a whole, enabling more informed and responsible decision-making. ► Why? This answer draws directly from the source's discussion of how economics connects resource use, fairness, and intergenerational sustainability. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: State the role of economics in recognising achievements and challenges 2. Step 2: Explain the concept of sustainable growth and its focus on future generations 3. Step 3: Mention specific topics studied and how they connect to decision-making [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	3
	OR Discuss the concept of dharma in early Indian thought, including its etymological meaning and its role in society. Answer: The idea of justice is closely linked to dharma, which does not mean religion but refers to duty, obligation, righteousness, and moral conduct. It represents a way of life in which ethical values are central, and individuals are expected to perform their duties according to their roles in society. The word dharma is derived from the Sanskrit root dhri, which is also the root of dharati (the earth). In the Mahābhārata, Bhishma says dharma is that which upholds beings. In Buddhism, the term dhamma—the Pāli equivalent—expresses similar ethical principles. Dharma thus functioned as a guiding principle for both individual conduct and social order. ► Why? The answer covers the definition, etymology, and textual references to dharma, showing its role as an ethical and social guiding principle rather than religion. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define dharma as duty, obligation, righteousness, and moral conduct rather than religion. 2. Step 2: Explain the etymological root dhri and Bhishma's statement in the Mahabharata. 3. Step 3: Mention the Buddhist equivalent dhamma and conclude on dharma's role in society. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	
27	Explain how Economics studies decision-making by consumers, producers, and governments.	3



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Economics helps us understand how individuals and societies decide how to use limited resources to meet their needs. It studies how goods and services are produced, exchanged, and distributed. Economics explores decision-making by three key groups: consumers decide what to buy, producers determine what and how much to produce, and governments frame policies to balance goals such as growth and stability, efficiency and fairness. In this way, economics is not only about numbers and markets but also about well-being, equity, and justice, shaping everyday life from the food we eat to the jobs people do. ► Why? The answer explains the three types of decision-makers in economics and the goals they pursue, as described in the source material. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define Economics as the study of using limited resources to meet needs 2. Step 2: Explain the roles of consumers, producers, and governments in decision-making 3. Step 3: Conclude that economics is about well-being, equity, and justice [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
	OR Explain the natural causes that led to the severe floods in Punjab in 2025. Answer: In 2025, Punjab faced very heavy monsoon rains, which were intensified by western disturbances that brought even more moisture and rain. It rained not only in Punjab but also in Himachal Pradesh and Jammu & Kashmir. The major rivers of Punjab—the Satluj, Beas, Ravi, and Ghaggar—were already flowing high before the heavy rains began. When additional rain fell, water from the hills and local rainfall caused rivers to overflow, leading to severe flooding in many parts of Punjab. The combination of pre-existing high river levels and additional heavy rainfall created a natural disaster. ► Why? The answer details the natural factors including heavy monsoon rains, western disturbances, rainfall in neighboring states, and overflowing rivers. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Mention the heavy monsoon rains intensified by western disturbances 2. Step 2: Note that rain also fell in Himachal Pradesh and Jammu & Kashmir 3. Step 3: Explain that the major rivers were already flowing high and overflowed with additional rain [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	
28	Explain how erosion affects different human occupations and livelihoods, giving specific examples. Answer: Erosion affects many human occupations by changing the land and soil on which people depend. For farmers, erosion removes the fertile topsoil needed for crop growth, leading to lower yields. For those living near rivers and coasts, erosion can wash away land, houses, and roads, causing damage and loss of property. In construction and mining, erosion destabilises land, posing safety risks. Even industries like tourism and fishing suffer, since beaches, rivers, and fertile lands may be destroyed. This shows that erosion not only shapes the Earth's surface but also directly affects human labour and livelihoods.	3



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	► Why? The answer requires students to connect erosion's physical effects to their impact on specific human occupations such as farming, construction, mining, tourism, and fishing. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: State that erosion changes land and soil that people depend on. 2. Step 2: Explain the impact on farmers, riverside/coastal dwellers, construction/mining workers, and tourism/fishing industries. 3. Step 3: Conclude that erosion directly affects human labour and livelihoods. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	
29	How does the verse from the Rig Veda reflect the idea of democratic traditions in early Indian thought? Answer: The verse from the Rig Veda (10.191.3), part of the Aikyamatyā Sūktam, reflects the idea of unity and collective decision-making. It states that their counsel is one and the same, their assembly is one, their mind is one, and their intention together is one. This suggests a shared guiding resolve and common purpose among the people. The idea that democracy has been a part of the Indian ethos since early times is reinforced by such references to assemblies and collective deliberation. The verse highlights the importance of consensus, shared intention, and unified participation, which are fundamental principles of democratic functioning even today. ► Why? The answer interprets the Rig Veda verse as presented in the source, connecting it to the concept of collective decision-making and democratic traditions in early India. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Identify the source of the verse (Rig Veda 10.191.3) 2. Step 2: Explain the meaning of unity in counsel, assembly, and mind 3. Step 3: Connect the verse to the idea that democracy was part of Indian ethos since early times [Ch 6: Democracy]	3
30	What was a ziggurat in Sumerian civilisation, and what role did it play in the city's social and economic life? Answer: A ziggurat was a tower-like stepped pyramid-shaped temple with several floors, above which the main temple was located. The top was a holy place, and the area around it contained palaces and royal storehouses. The surrounding walls had only one entrance, as the ziggurat also served as the city's treasury. Each city built a grand ziggurat for its chief god, and the city grew around this main temple. All economic activities — agriculture, trade, and transport of goods — were tied to the temple authority. Entry was restricted to high priests and priestesses, who were probably part of the ruling class, reflecting a clear division of social hierarchy in Mesopotamian society. ► Why? The answer describes the physical structure of the ziggurat and its central role in economic, religious, and social life in Sumerian cities. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define the ziggurat as a stepped pyramid-shaped temple 2. Step 2: Describe its physical features — multiple floors, single entrance, treasury function 3. Step 3: Explain its role as the centre of economic activity and how restricted entry reflected social hierarchy	3



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	[Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	
Section D Attempt 4 out of 6.		
31	Climate change is one of the most urgent challenges facing the Earth today. Discuss the causes and consequences of climate change, and explain how individuals can contribute to reducing its impact through their carbon footprint. Answer: Climate change refers to long-term changes in weather patterns, such as temperature, rainfall, and wind. It is caused mainly by human activities, including the burning of fossil fuels, deforestation, and industrial pollution that releases gases like carbon dioxide into the atmosphere. These actions increase greenhouse gases such as carbon dioxide, methane, nitrous oxide, and water vapour in the atmosphere, which trap heat and raise global temperatures. The consequences of climate change are severe and wide-ranging. We are witnessing more frequent floods, droughts, melting of glaciers, rising sea levels, and loss of biodiversity. Climate change not only threatens ecosystems but also impacts human health, agriculture, and livelihoods. It has a great impact on almost all sections of the population, including women and children. To reduce climate change, collective efforts are required. A carbon footprint is the total amount of greenhouse gases released into the atmosphere as a result of human activities, such as energy use, transportation, or the production of goods and services. Individuals can reduce their carbon footprint by saving energy, using renewable sources of energy, protecting forests, and adopting sustainable lifestyles. Simple daily habits matter — using public transport or walking instead of private cars, switching off electrical appliances when not in use, using water judiciously, and reusing, recycling, and avoiding single-use plastics all contribute. Reducing carbon footprints and living in more eco-friendly ways means every small step counts, and every human being plays a vital role in shaping a healthier and greener future. ► Why? The question integrates the causes, consequences, and individual-level mitigation of climate change, connecting greenhouse gas emissions to carbon footprint reduction strategies. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Define climate change and identify its main human causes — burning fossil fuels, deforestation, and industrial pollution. 2. Step 2: Explain how greenhouse gases (carbon dioxide, methane, nitrous oxide, water vapour) trap heat and raise global temperatures. 3. Step 3: Describe the consequences — floods, droughts, melting glaciers, rising sea levels, loss of biodiversity, and impacts on health, agriculture, and livelihoods. 4. Step 4: Define carbon footprint and explain how individual actions like reducing energy use, using renewable energy, protecting forests, and sustainable living help. 5. Step 5: Conclude by emphasising that collective efforts and every small step count in shaping a healthier and greener future. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	OR Discuss the various sources used by historians to understand the social realities of the past. How do different historical traditions, including the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition and modern historiography, contribute to the study of history? Answer: History is the study of the human past, helping societies understand people's experiences, values, and changes over time. Different historical traditions have used various methods to preserve cultural memory. In Bharat, the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition shares historical information through stories, giving cultural meaning to events and reinforcing enduring ideals and values. In contrast, modern historiography increasingly relies on empirical evidence and scientific tools like human genetics, carbon-14 dating, and archaeology to establish timelines. To understand social realities, historians draw on a wide range of sources. Literary sources include travelogues, memoirs, correspondence, genealogical records, folklore, and oral traditions. Archaeological sources consist of material remains such as monuments, architectural structures, excavated sites, artefacts, and art like sculptures and paintings, which often require scientific instruments and laboratory testing for analysis. Additionally, epigraphic sources provide direct evidence through texts, decrees, or records inscribed on durable materials like stone, metal plates, or rock surfaces, revealing information about past events, rulers, and administration. Numismatic sources, comprising coins, currency, or medals, help historians study the economy, chronology, trade, and political boundaries through the metal content, inscriptions, and symbols on coins. By combining these diverse traditions and sources, history not only documents what happened but also transmits cultural values from one generation to the next. ► Why? The answer explains the diverse methods and sources—literary, archaeological, epigraphic, and numismatic—used in history writing, contrasting traditional storytelling with modern empirical methods. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce history as the study of the human past and the need to understand social realities. 2. Step 2: Contrast the itihāsa-purāṇa tradition's storytelling approach with modern historiography's reliance on empirical evidence and scientific tools. 3. Step 3: Detail the literary sources such as travelogues, memoirs, and oral traditions. 4. Step 4: Explain archaeological, epigraphic, and numismatic sources, providing specific examples of each from the material. 5. Step 5: Conclude by summarizing how these combined sources help transmit cultural values and establish timelines. [Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
32	India is recognised as the world's largest democracy, not merely in terms of numbers but through the sustained involvement of its people. Describe in detail the features that demonstrate the scale, depth, and inclusiveness of Indian democracy.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: India's democracy stands out for its scale, depth, and inclusiveness. With over 96.8 crore registered voters in 2024, it represents an unparalleled exercise in public participation. This vast electorate reflects not only the size of the population but also the extensive reach of its democratic institutions. On average, a Member of Parliament represents about 25 lakh people (2019), showing the enormous scale at which democratic representation operates in India. Elections in India are conducted in 22 scheduled languages, along with several other languages, ensuring linguistic inclusiveness. Election symbols are used so that every citizen, including those who cannot read, can vote independently. This makes the electoral process accessible to all sections of society. More than one million polling stations are set up across the country, including those in remote areas such as mountains, forests, deserts, and islands. In some cases, polling stations are created even for a single voter, ensuring that no citizen is left behind. India has over 2,800 registered political parties, reflecting the country's social and regional diversity and allowing many viewpoints to compete peacefully. The Indian electorate includes people from varied linguistic, religious, and socio-economic backgrounds, all participating within a single democratic framework. The ability to conduct regular, nationwide elections for such a large and diverse population highlights the institutional strength and organisational capacity of Indian democracy. Elections become a collective national exercise in which voices from different regions and communities are expressed through the ballot. This continuous and widespread public participation reinforces India's position as the world's largest democracy—not merely in terms of numbers, but through the sustained involvement of its people in shaping governance and public life. ► Why? The answer highlights India's democratic scale through voter numbers, linguistic inclusiveness, polling station reach, political party diversity, and the institutional capacity to conduct nationwide elections for a vast and diverse population. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce India as the world's largest democracy with over 96.8 crore registered voters in 2024. 2. Step 2: Explain the scale of representation — an MP represents about 25 lakh people on average (2019). 3. Step 3: Describe inclusiveness through 22 scheduled languages, election symbols for non-literate voters, and over one million polling stations including remote areas. 4. Step 4: Highlight the diversity of over 2,800 registered political parties reflecting social and regional diversity. 5. Step 5: Conclude by explaining how sustained public participation across varied backgrounds makes Indian democracy truly 'living' and not just numerically large. [Ch 6: Democracy]	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	OR Describe the system of village governance in the Chola empire with special reference to the Uttaramerur inscription and the Kudavolai system. How did the village assemblies function as self-reliant institutions? Answer: The village was the smallest unit within a district in the Chola empire, and village councils or assemblies played an important role in settling disputes and managing local affairs. The village assemblies were responsible for all local administrative functions, including revenue collection, land management, irrigation, road construction, and record maintenance. They functioned as independent, self-reliant institutions and were not dependent on the government for patronage. The Uttaramerur inscription of Parantaka I (10th century) provides a vivid description of village governance. Located in the Vaikuntha Perumal Temple in Kanchipuram district of Tamil Nadu, these Tamil inscriptions furnish details about the functioning of village assemblies and inform us about the Kudavolai, or the 'ballot pot' system used in village elections. In this system, the names of eligible candidates were written on palm leaves and placed inside a large pot. During a public gathering, a young child was asked to draw the leaves, one by one, to select representatives for the village assembly and its various committees. To ensure fairness, the draw took place in full view of the community, often at a temple. The elected members were then divided into specialised committees called variyams, each entrusted with important village responsibilities, such as managing irrigation (the tank committee), administering justice, and collecting taxes. The inscription also specifies that candidates should have 'honest earnings' and be 'pure' of mind, showing the connection between ethical principles and governance. Thus, the Chola village assemblies demonstrated a well-organised, democratic, and ethically grounded system of local self-governance. ► Why? The question tests understanding of Chola-era village governance, the Kudavolai election system, and the self-reliant nature of village assemblies as described in the Uttaramerur inscription. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce the role of village assemblies in the Chola empire and their administrative functions. 2. Step 2: Describe the Uttaramerur inscription of Parantaka I — its location and significance. 3. Step 3: Explain the Kudavolai or ballot pot system in detail — palm leaves, pot, child drawing leaves, public gathering. 4. Step 4: Discuss the specialised committees (variyaams) and their responsibilities such as irrigation, justice, and tax collection. 5. Step 5: Conclude by highlighting how village assemblies functioned as independent, self-reliant institutions with ethical requirements for candidates. [Ch 5: State and Society up to 1000 CE]	
33	Trace the evolutionary sequence of human ancestors from Homo habilis to Homo sapiens, describing the key technological advancements associated with each stage. How did the development of tools mark the beginning of 'human behaviour'?	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: Human beings came to be known as 'hominins', or tool makers, and it was around 3.3 million years ago that one of these ancestors made the earliest stone tools. This marked the beginning of so-called 'human behaviour', as opposed to the behaviour of animals, who do not possess the cognitive ability to make such tools. Tools functioned as extra-corporal limbs, acting as extensions of the human body to perform tasks people could not accomplish with their hands alone. Homo habilis, the 'handy man', lived in Africa, especially in the Olduvai Gorge in Tanzania and Kenya, about 2-6 million years ago, and made chopper stone tools. Their successors, Homo erectus, lived in the Eastern African Rift Valley about 2 million years ago and were the inventors of handaxes and cleavers. They were among the first to migrate out of Africa, gradually spreading into Europe and Asia. Homo neanderthalensis lived in Europe and Southwest Asia till about 40,000 years ago and made Middle Palaeolithic flake tools. Homo sapiens, the only human species living today, developed complex technologies. They invented the bow and arrow, parallel-sided blade and microblade tools made from rocks with glassy texture, and produced beads of stone, bone, and shell. They also used a distinctive stone tool called a burin to engrave symbolic features on bones and shells. While all human ancestors were tool makers, it was Homo sapiens that developed the most advanced technologies and gradually spread all over the world, including Australia and the Americas, between 50,000 and 12,000 years ago. ► Why? The question traces the progression of human ancestors and their increasingly sophisticated tool-making abilities, highlighting how tool creation distinguished early humans from animals and laid the foundation for civilisation. ► Step-by-step: 1. Step 1: Introduce the concept of hominins as tool makers and the significance of the earliest stone tools around 3.3 million years ago. 2. Step 2: Describe Homo habilis — their location in Africa, time period, and chopper stone tools. 3. Step 3: Explain Homo erectus — their migration out of Africa, and invention of handaxes and cleavers. 4. Step 4: Discuss Homo neanderthalensis and their Middle Palaeolithic flake tools. 5. Step 5: Detail Homo sapiens' complex technologies including bow and arrow, microblades, burins, and beads, and their global spread. Conclude with the distinction that while all ancestors were tool makers, Homo sapiens developed the most complex technologies. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	
34	Explain the structure of the Earth's interior and describe how the movement of tectonic plates shapes the Earth's surface. Include the different types of plate boundaries and their associated landforms in your answer.	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	Answer: The Earth is composed of three main layers: the crust, mantle, and core. The crust is the outermost layer, while the mantle beneath it is thick and hot. The innermost core is extremely hot and heavy. The crust and the upper part of the mantle form the lithosphere, which is broken into massive solid rock slabs called tectonic plates. These plates are of three types: continental, oceanic, and mixed. Beneath the lithosphere lies the semi-molten asthenosphere. Heat from the Earth's core causes molten material in the mantle to rise and cooler material to sink, creating convection currents that push and pull the tectonic plates. The movement of these plates shapes the Earth's surface at plate boundaries. At convergent boundaries, plates move towards each other. When continental plates collide, they form fold mountains like the Himalaya. When an oceanic plate collides with a continental plate, the oceanic plate sinks, leading to volcanic activity and earthquakes. At divergent boundaries, plates move away from each other, allowing magma to rise and form new crust, creating features like mid-ocean ridges, such as the Mid-Atlantic Ridge. At transform boundaries, plates slide past each other without creating or destroying crust, mainly causing earthquakes, such as along the San Andreas Fault. Most earthquakes and volcanoes occur along these boundaries, especially around the Pacific Ocean, an area known as the Ring of Fire. ► Why? <i>The Earth's internal structure drives plate tectonics through convection currents, and the interactions at plate boundaries create major landforms and natural disasters.</i> ► Step-by-step: <i>Step 1: Introduce the Earth's three main layers and the formation of the lithosphere and asthenosphere.</i> <i>Step 2: Explain the role of convection currents in the mantle causing the movement of tectonic plates.</i> <i>Step 3: Describe the three types of plate boundaries: convergent, divergent, and transform.</i> <i>Step 4: Provide examples of landforms and events associated with each boundary type (e.g., Himalaya, Mid-Atlantic Ridge, San Andreas Fault).</i> <i>Step 5: Conclude with the significance of plate boundaries in the distribution of earthquakes and volcanoes, mentioning the Ring of Fire.</i> <i>[Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]</i>	
Section E Attempt 3 out of 4.		



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
35	Case Study: Weathering, Erosion, and Human Livelihoods In a region with rocky terrain, plant roots grow into cracks in rocks, gradually splitting them apart. Temperature changes further break the rocks into smaller pieces, but the broken material does not move. Meanwhile, in nearby dry and sandy areas, wind carries away loose soil, and in coastal areas, sea waves wear away the land along the shore. For farmers in this region, the removal of fertile topsoil has led to lower crop yields. Those living near rivers and coasts face land being washed away, damaging houses and roads. Construction and mining activities have become risky as the land has become unstable. Even tourism and fishing suffer as beaches and fertile lands are degraded. (i) Identify the process by which plant roots split rocks apart and name its type. (ii) Distinguish between weathering and erosion based on the movement of material. (iii) Identify the two types of erosion mentioned in the passage and explain how each affects farmers and coastal residents respectively. (iv) Why does erosion pose a safety risk specifically in construction and mining? Answer: (i) The process is weathering, and the type is biological weathering, which is caused by plants, animals, or micro-organisms. (ii) Weathering only breaks down rocks into smaller pieces and does not involve movement of the broken material. Erosion involves both the wearing away and the carrying or movement of the broken material from one place to another by natural agents. (iii) Wind erosion (common in dry and sandy areas) removes fertile topsoil, leading to lower crop yields for farmers. Coastal erosion (where sea waves wear away land along the shore) washes away land, houses, and roads, causing damage and loss of property for coastal residents. (iv) Erosion destabilises land, which poses safety risks in construction and mining because the ground becomes unstable and unsafe for these activities. ► Why? i) The process is weathering, and the type is biological weathering, which is caused by plants, animals, or micro-organisms. ii) Weathering only breaks down rocks into smaller pieces and does not involve movement of the broken material. Erosion involves both the wearing away and the carrying or movement of the broken material from one place to another by natural agents. iii) Wind erosion (common in dry and sandy areas) removes fertile topsoil, leading to lower crop yields for farmers. Coastal erosion (where sea waves wear away land along the shore) washes away land, houses, and roads, causing damage and loss of property for coastal residents. iv) Erosion destabilises land, which poses safety risks in construction and mining because the ground becomes unstable and unsafe for these activities. [Ch 2: Shaping of the Earth's Surface]	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	OR Case Study: Understanding Society Through a Village's Daily Life A village in India is situated near a long coastline that historically facilitated contact with Africa, Europe, and Southeast Asia. The villagers depend on farming, while some engage in trade. The local Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in local development planning, reflecting grassroots democracy. Roads are maintained by public authorities, and electricity arrives from distant power stations through a vast network. The food villagers eat has been harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Social Science helps explain why agriculture flourishes here, how governments make decisions affecting millions, and how environments influence life. Society does not function by chance—it is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. (i) Define Social Science in simple words. (ii) How does the Panchayati Raj system embody grassroots democracy in India's villages? (iii) Explain how the village's daily life demonstrates the interconnection of multiple Social Science disciplines. Refer to at least two disciplines. (iv) Why does the passage state that 'society does not function by chance'? What factors shape it? Answer: (i) Social Science is the systematic study of human society. (ii) The Panchayati Raj system embodies grassroots democracy by giving citizens a voice in local development planning, showing that political power exists not only within formal institutions but also in social relationships, customs, and ideas of legitimacy. (iii) The village's daily life connects multiple disciplines: Geography explains why the coastline facilitated contact with other regions and how the environment influences farming and settlement. Political Science explains how the Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in governance. Economics explains how food is harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Each discipline asks different questions, yet all are interconnected and together provide a holistic understanding of society. (iv) Society is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. Social Science helps explore questions about society through careful observation, evidence, and logical reasoning. ► Why? i) Social Science is the systematic study of human society. ii) The Panchayati Raj system embodies grassroots democracy by giving citizens a voice in local development planning, showing that political power exists not only within formal institutions but also in social relationships, customs, and ideas of legitimacy. iii) The village's daily life connects multiple disciplines: Geography explains why the coastline facilitated contact with other regions and how the environment influences farming and settlement. Political Science explains how the Panchayati Raj system gives citizens a voice in governance. Economics explains how food is harvested, processed, transported, bought, and sold through the efforts of many people. Each discipline asks different questions, yet all are interconnected and together provide a holistic understanding of society. iv) Society is shaped by history, geography, institutions, resources, and human choices. Social Science helps explore questions about society through careful observation, evidence, and logical reasoning.	



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
	[Ch 1: Understanding Social Science]	
36	Case Study: Punjab Floods 2025 In 2025, Punjab experienced severe floods due to heavy monsoon rains and the consecutive swelling of the rivers Satluj, Beas, and Ravi. The floods damaged large parts of the state, including villages, agricultural fields, houses, and infrastructure such as roads and bridges. The disaster was triggered by very heavy monsoon rains intensified by western disturbances that brought more moisture. Additionally, weak and old river embankments known as dhusi bandh, construction of houses and farms near rivers, and silt accumulation in dams worsened the situation. The floods led to loss of lives, displacement to relief camps, damage to paddy crops, and outbreaks of waterborne diseases. (i) Which rivers are mentioned as swelling and causing severe flooding in Punjab? (ii) How did western disturbances contribute to the flooding in Punjab? (iii) Explain two human-made factors that aggravated the floods in Punjab. (iv) What was one major health consequence of the murky standing water left by the floods? Answer: (i) The rivers Satluj, Beas, and Ravi. (ii) Western disturbances brought even more moisture and rain, which intensified the very heavy monsoon rains. (iii) Two human-made factors were: 1) Weak and old river embankments (dhusi bandh) that could not stop rising water, and 2) People building houses and farms too close to the rivers, reducing the natural space for floodwater to spread safely. Other factors include silt accumulation reducing river capacity and late flood warnings. (iv) The spread of waterborne diseases and sanitation concerns. ► Why? i) The rivers Satluj, Beas, and Ravi. ii) Western disturbances brought even more moisture and rain, which intensified the very heavy monsoon rains. iii) Two human-made factors were: 1) Weak and old river embankments (dhusi bandh) that could not stop rising water, and 2) People building houses and farms too close to the rivers, reducing the natural space for floodwater to spread safely. Other factors include silt accumulation reducing river capacity and late flood warnings. iv) The spread of waterborne diseases and sanitation concerns. [Ch 3: Atmosphere and Climate]	5



Q.NO.	QUESTIONS	MARKS
37	Case Study: Egyptian Civilisation — Calendar, Agriculture and Governance About 5000 years ago, farmers discovered that by digging ditches they could divert water from the Nile into their fields and store water in reservoirs for later use. By counting the days between Nile floods, the Egyptians developed a calendar. The Egyptian calendar has three seasons — Inundation (autumn), Peret growing (winter) and shemu harvest (summer). It is based on the rising of Sirius (Dog Star), with a year of 365 days. The need to dig ditches and construct dams required collective effort, which led to the growth of local government and the rise of an administrative class — probably the earliest form of local government in Egypt. (i) What are the three seasons of the Egyptian calendar? (ii) On what astronomical basis was the Egyptian calendar founded? (iii) How did agricultural needs contribute to the rise of local government in Egypt? (iv) Why was the Egyptian calendar of 365 days not perfectly accurate? Answer: (i) Inundation (autumn), Peret growing (winter), and shemu harvest (summer). (ii) It was based on the rising of Sirius, the Dog Star. (iii) The need to dig ditches and construct dams required collective effort. These early cooperative efforts led to the growth of local government and the rise of an administrative class, forming the earliest form of local government in Egypt. (iv) The real year is about $\frac{1}{4}$ day longer than 365 days, so the calendar lost time over the years. ► Why? i) Inundation (autumn), Peret growing (winter), and shemu harvest (summer). ii) It was based on the rising of Sirius, the Dog Star. iii) The need to dig ditches and construct dams required collective effort. These early cooperative efforts led to the growth of local government and the rise of an administrative class, forming the earliest form of local government in Egypt. iv) The real year is about $\frac{1}{4}$ day longer than 365 days, so the calendar lost time over the years. [Ch 4: Early Humans and Beginning of Civilisation]	5

